

Quick Start – How do I report a bug, an issue, or a task?

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-07-14T21:50:00Z **Authority:** constitution §11.4.202 (reporting directives) + §11.4.140 (action-prefix grammar) **Maintainer:** constitution submodule **Scope:** the one-page version. Full detail: [USER_GUIDE.md](#) · [REFERENCE.md](#)

The three commands

Type one of these as the **first line** of your prompt, then just describe the problem in plain language:

```
BUG:  subtitles render one frame late on the secondary display
TASK: bump the pandoc pin to 3.2 and regenerate the exports
ISSUE: playback stutters on 4K HDR after ~40 minutes – not sure if bug or
       feature gap
```

Use	When
BUG:	Something is broken — a regression, a defect, wrong behaviour a user can see.
TASK:	Internal workstream — refactor, doc, infra, gate, audit, chore.
ISSUE:	Anything trackable when you have not decided which of the two it is.

Equivalent forms, if you prefer them: `BUG :: ...` , `BUG ---> ...` , `/helix:bug ...` , `/default-bug ...` . (Bare `/bug` is **Claude Code's own built-in** — use `BUG:` or `/helix:bug` instead.) `/task ...` and `/issue ...` work directly.

What makes a good report

You do not need a template — write it as you would to a colleague. Include what you know; the agent records anything you did not say as an explicit `UNKNOWN:` gap rather than inventing it.

- **What** happens, and what you expected instead.
- **Where** — which app / device / screen / build.
- **How to reproduce** it, if you know.
- **How you would know it is fixed** (the acceptance condition).

What the system does with it

1. **Creates a real, tracked workable item** — never a prose "yes, I'll look into it". Status `Queued` , a stable auto-incremented ticket id, the correct Type (`Bug` / `Feature` / `Task` — there is no fourth type), and a structured description (what / scope / reproduction / acceptance).
2. **Regenerates every derived document** from the workable-items database — the open and closed trackers, their summaries, and their `.md` / `.html` / `.pdf` / `.docx` siblings. Nothing is left stale.
3. **Pushes it to every configured external tracker.**
4. For `ISSUE` , if your text does not make the type obvious, **it asks you first** rather than guessing.
5. For `BUG` , if the defect is actionable now, it then **investigates the root cause before proposing any fix.**

What it reports back to you

- the **assigned ticket id**;
- the **sync verdict** (which documents were regenerated);
- **each tracker's verdict**, with the path to the captured evidence.

A tracker whose credentials or client are missing is reported as an honest **SKIP with the reason** (naming only the unset variable, never a value). A push is **never faked** and its absence is **never hidden** — if a tracker was skipped, you will be told.

The guarantee

A report that is only acknowledged is a lost requirement. Every report becomes a real tracked item, or it is explicitly and honestly refused. Nothing evaporates.